two armed men with handguns and grenades released 19 women and children. In Algiers the hijackers demanded release of Shiites held in Israeli jails or they would execute the passengers. Again they released another 21 mostly women and children. In early afternoon (here) they were in the air and headed back to Beirut.

June 15

An early call again. The plane has landed in Beirut about 2:20 A.M. their time. They had shot one hostage in the head and dumped his body out on to the runway. In the confusion there where Nabih Bern's Moslem Shiites run the airport, we would learn later that ten more terrorists boarded the plane. Before the night was over they were on their way back to Algiers where they released several Greeks on the plane in a trade for the one Greek who had helped them in Athens and who had been arrested. He went on board and joined his evil cohorts. Another 53 hostages again women were released. We're down now to about 40 men, mostly American, but they then released 10 men. Total on board now, three crew and 30 men . . .

June 16

We all decided after more night and early morning calls we should cancel an appearance I was to make this afternoon and get back here to the W.H. Had an N.S.C. meeting. It's a frustrating situation. We have forces in the area—a specially trained unit, but it couldn't be used in the hostile atmosphere of Beirut.

The demand is still for the Shiites held in Israel. These are people the Israelis intend to release in a few weeks, but they are unwilling to let it appear that they are giving in to hijackers' demands. I suggested there might be a way to do it and turn it around on the